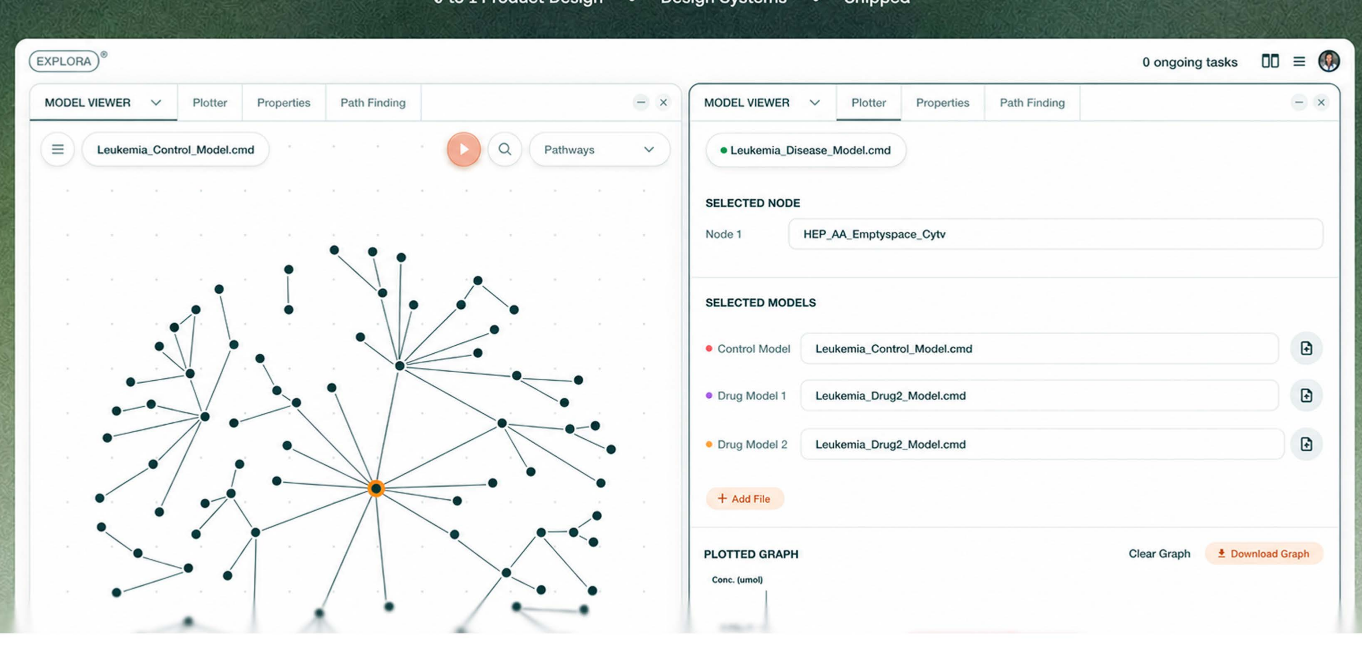
Case Study by Matija Milosevic

Empowering scientists to deliver faster personalized cancer care

0 to 1 Product Design • Design Systems • Shipped



Product *Explora*

A specialized biotech tool designed to accelerate cancer research. By unifying complex drug simulations and AI-driven cell modeling, Explora helps scientists identify personalized therapies for patients in record time.

Problem *Digital Chaos*

Before Explora (the product), scientists juggled 9+ legacy tools and spreadsheets, causing high cognitive load and long manual tasks that created a productivity lag in cancer research.

Details

year
2026

type of product
Web-based tool, IDE

my role
Principal Product Designer (individual designer)

team members
CEO · 1 Product Manager · 2 Developers

scope
0 to 1 Product Strategy · UX/UI · Design System

tools
Figma · Figma Make · Claude · ChatGPT · Stitch · Weave

Solution *A Centralized IDE*

I led the 0 to 1 design to unify fractured systems into a singular IDE, enabling scientists to conduct research within one platform.

Result *Productivity Gains*

I established the company's first design system of ~80+ components. Product's first launch ensured 100% organization-wide adoption, reducing task time by 12.5% and saving nearly~$1.2M in annual productivity costs.

Impact

~$1.2M
Recovered in Productivity
Based on ~1 hr/day saved per user

100%
Organization Wide Adoption
From C-Suite to Research Scientists

9→1
Systems Consolidated
Unified legacy chaos into a single IDE

CONTEXT

Cellworks is a *biotech company* focused on *curing cancer.*

and how do they do that? They built a machine learning model that simulates human cell behavior. By running FDA-approved drug simulations on it, they identify the most effective and personalised therapies for cancer patients' unique DNA.

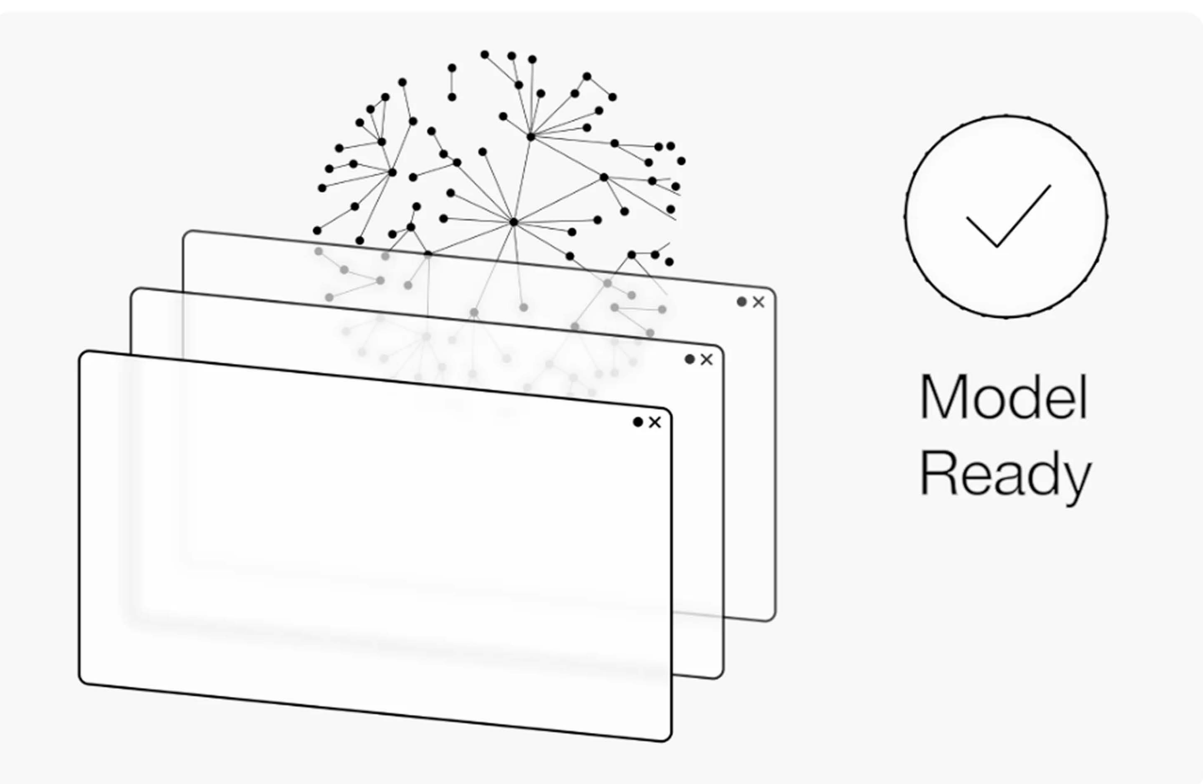
Scientists worked on the bio-model to update it as per new research findings and engineers worked on refining the model to produce more accurate results.

PROBLEM

Scientists' & engineers' *productivity* was at an *all-time low.* Their *tools* & systems were *slowing them down, delaying research.*

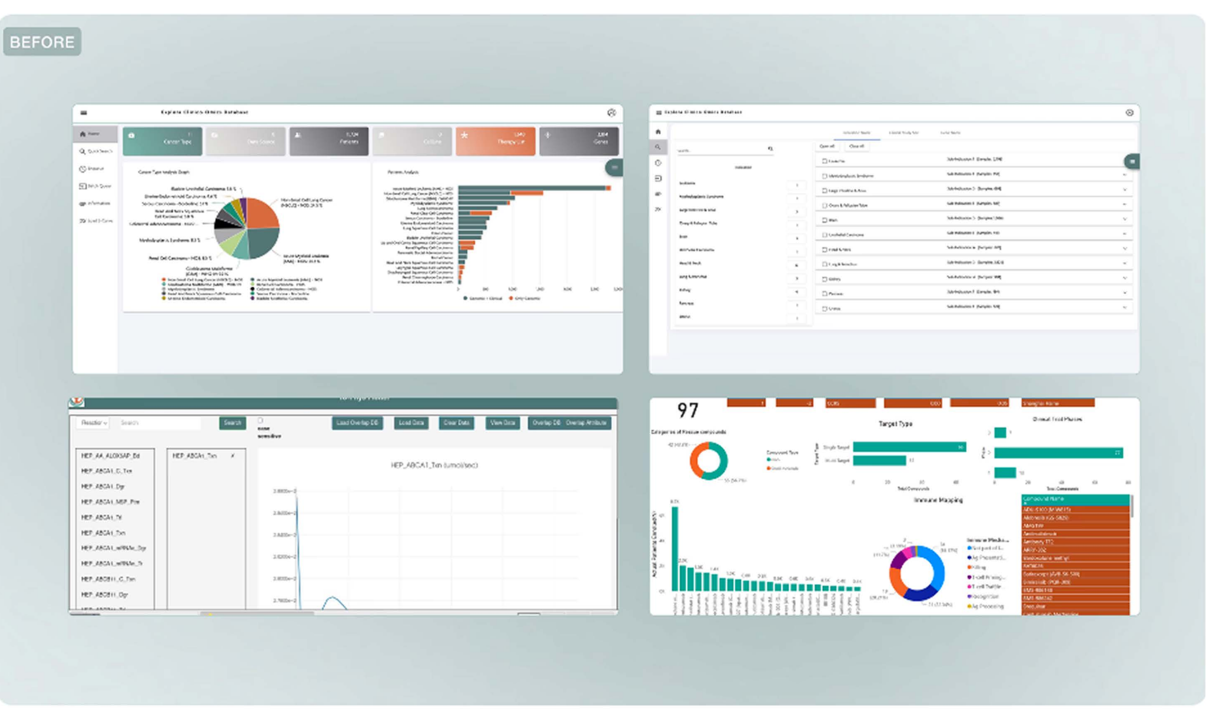
Scientists & engineers were stuck juggling too many tools, delaying cancer patient care. This is what they were dealing with,

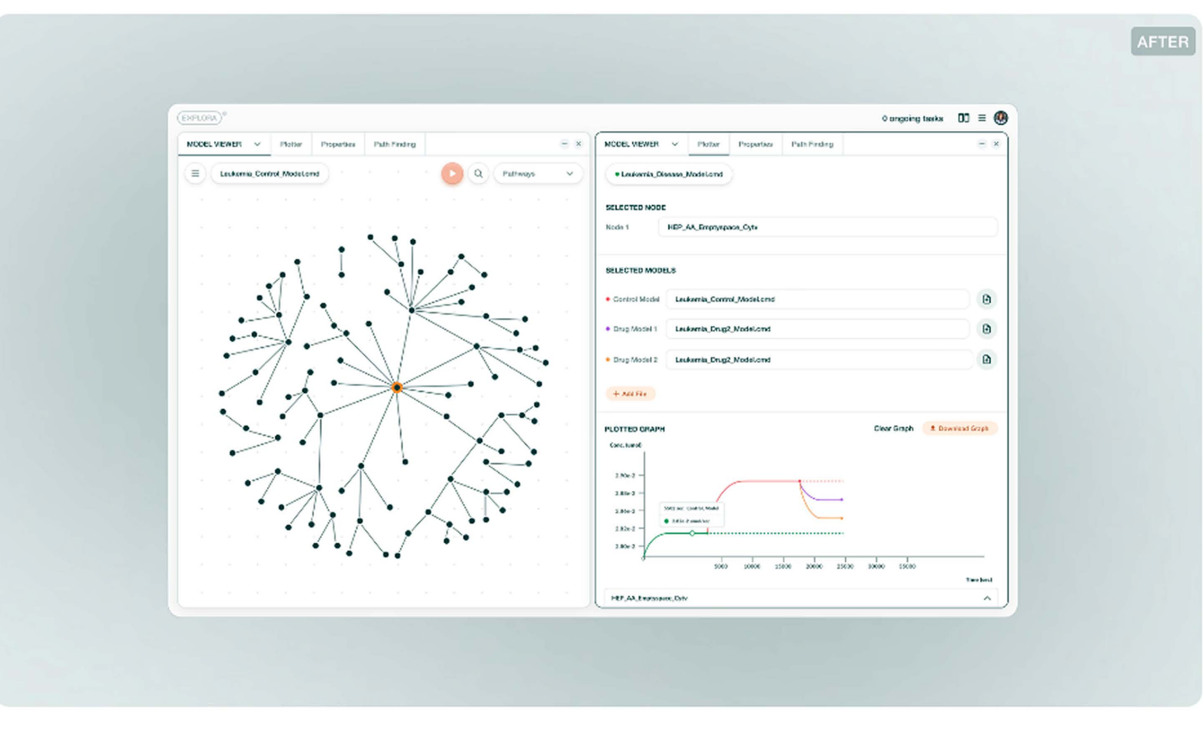
- Waiting a long time for systems to process
- Dealing with the cognitive strain due to tool-hopping



GOALS + NORTH STAR

To design a *unified R&D platform*, from the ground up to *accelerate the delivery* of personalized cancer care.



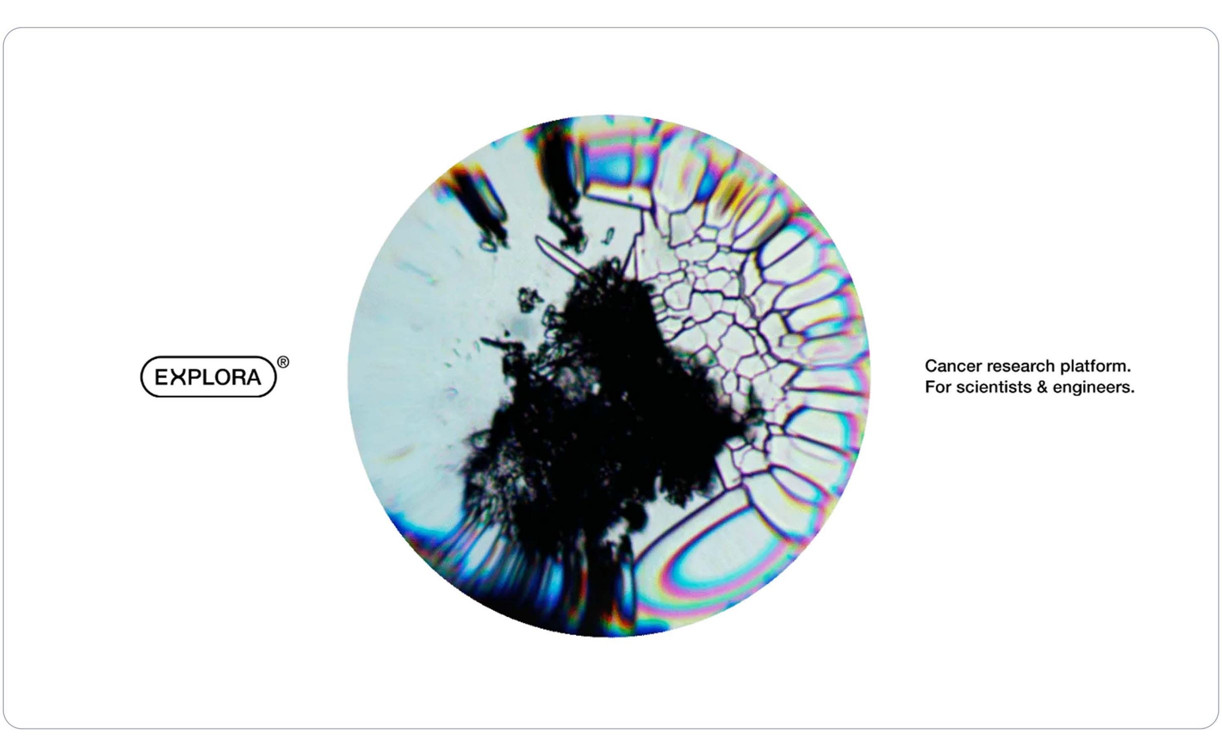


PROCESS + KEY INSIGHTS

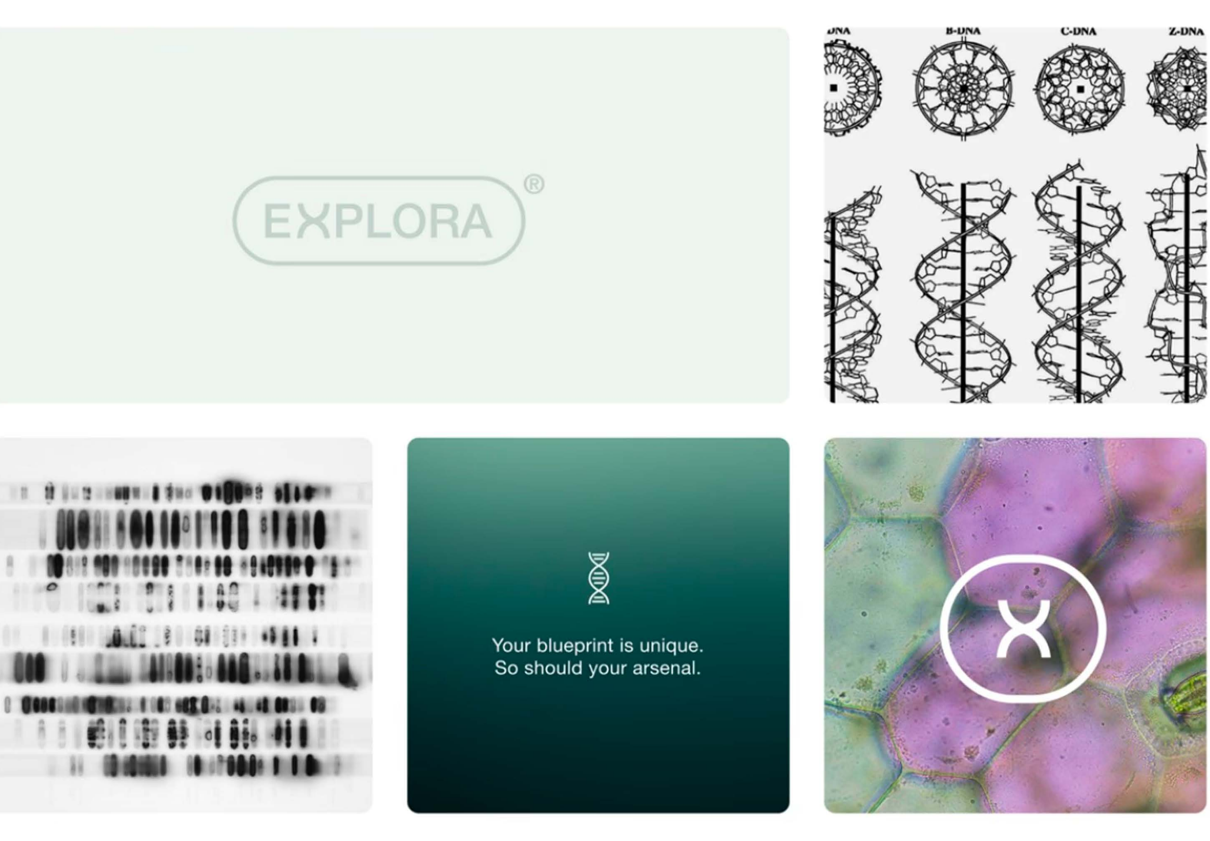
I conducted contextual inquiries and *interviews* with computational *biologists*, machine learning *engineers*, and leadership to *map disjointed R&D workflows* and *visualize a unified research ecosystem.*

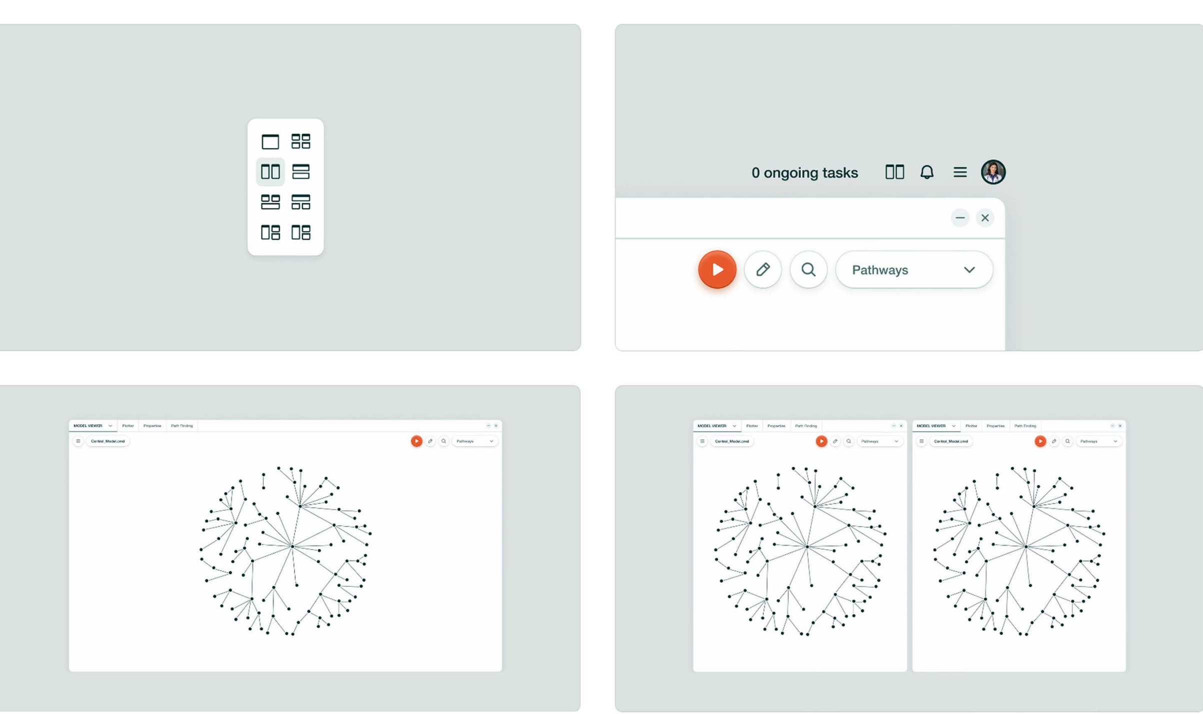
SOLUTION

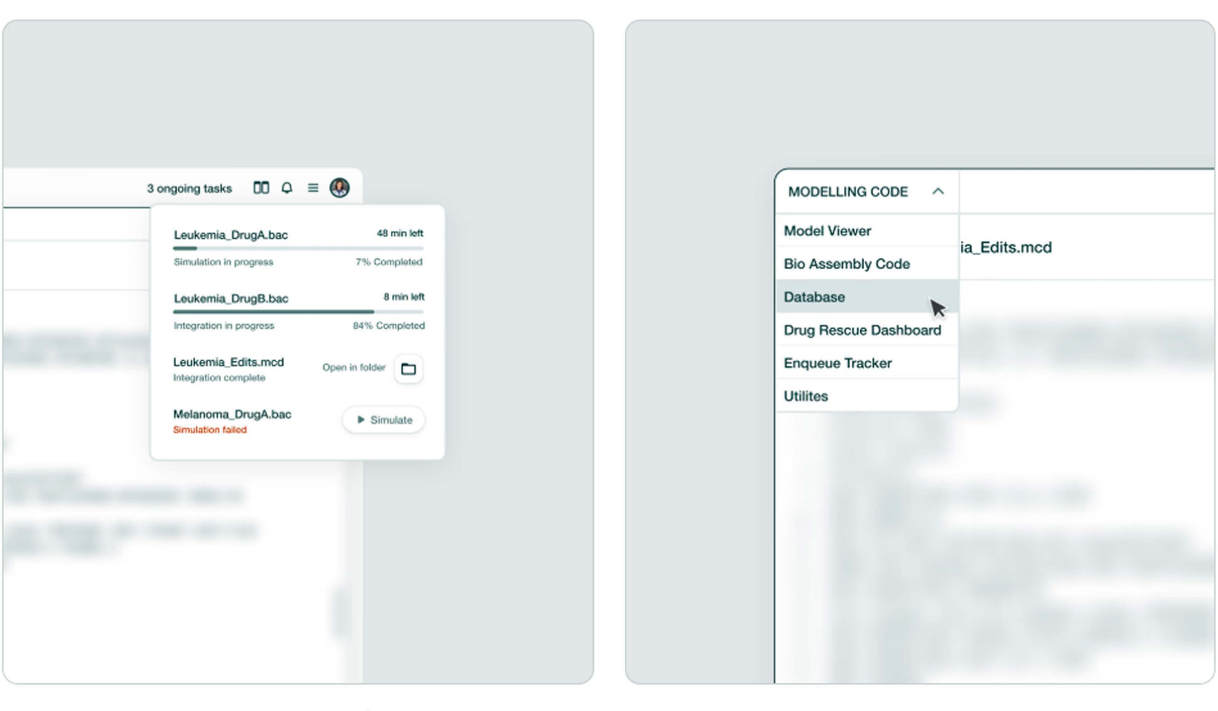
Explora, a scalable, systems-driven MVP consolidating legacy tools into a high-performance workspace that empowers scientists & engineers *to conduct cancer research faster.*



BRANDING







"translating requirements" to becoming a co-innovator who made complex data more actionable.

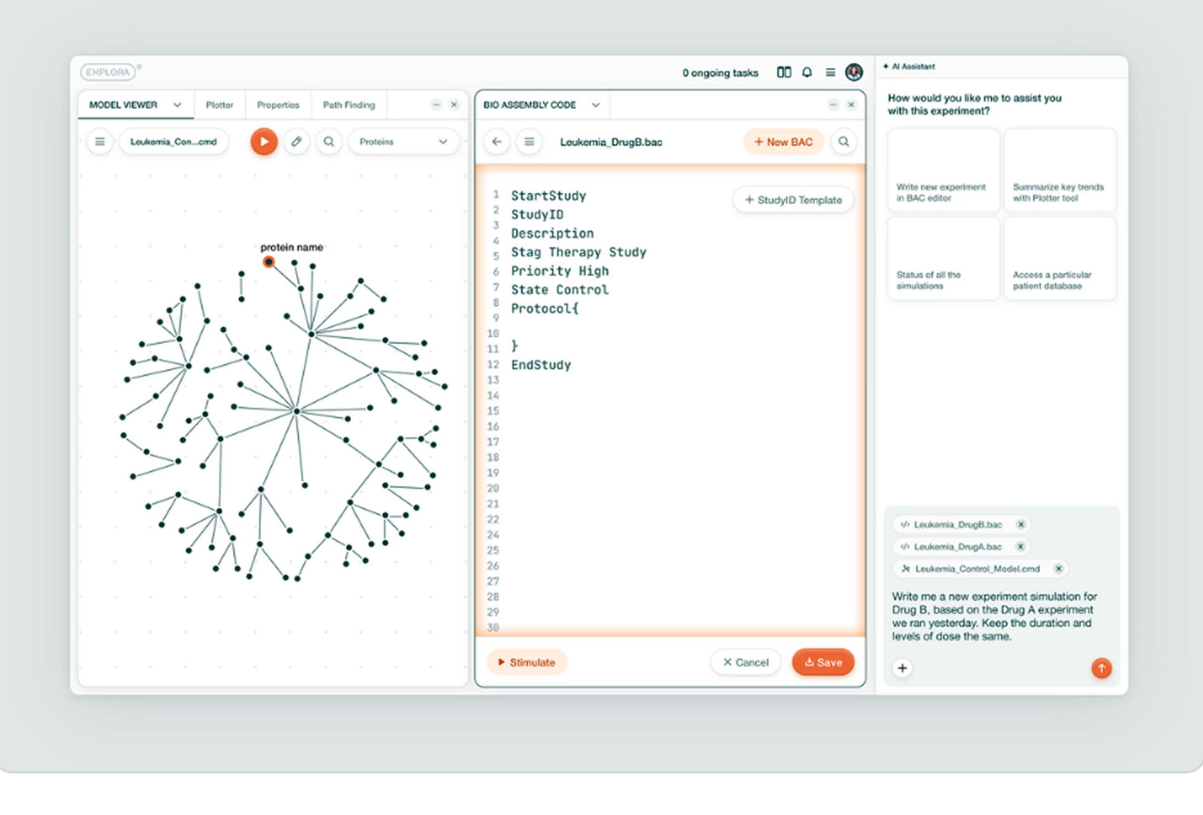
system, allowing us to hit a tight launch deadline while keeping the platform scalable.

the cognitive strain of tool-hopping, helping scientists stay focused on their research instead of their software.

WHAT I WOULD DO NEXT..

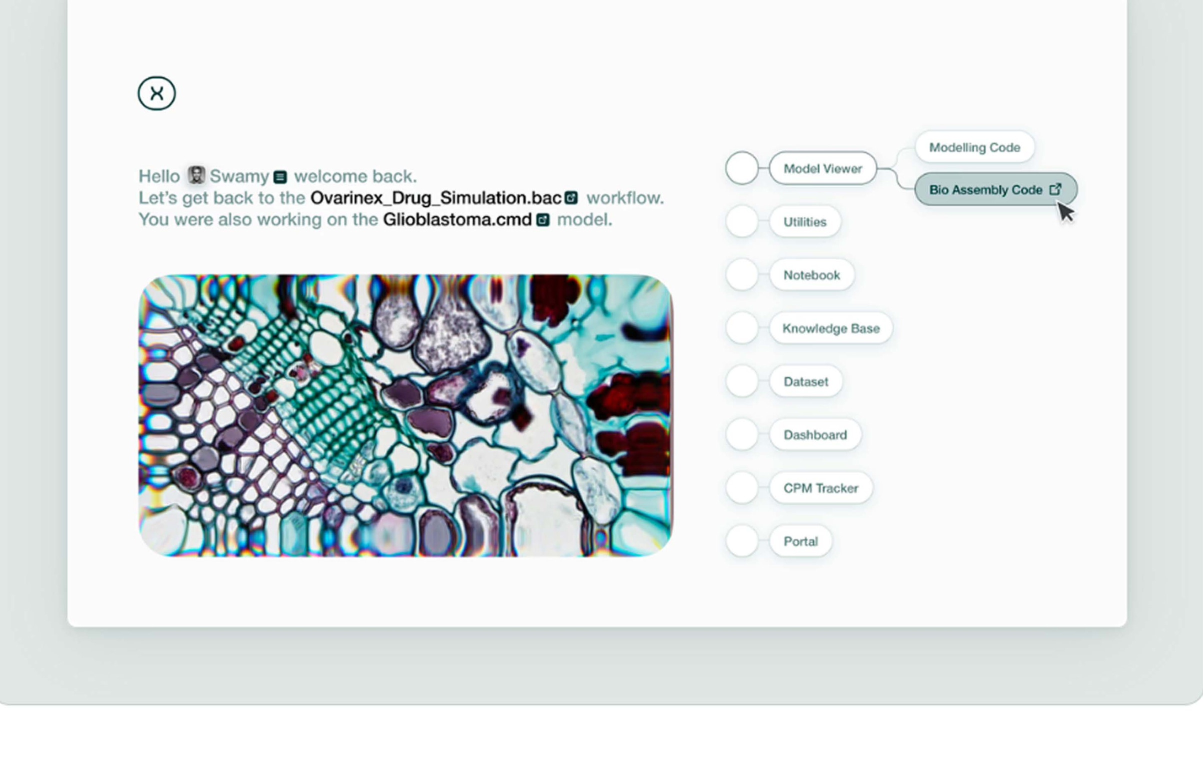
Introduce an *AI-powered chat assistant*

Biotech is one of the fastest growing areas where AI is being used extensively for research. Leveraging it, I'd focus on introducing an AI-powered chat assistant primarily focused on automating many of the daily tasks.



Experiment a little with the *homepage design*

Here is a conceptual user interface that I designed as an answer to the question: what would a conversational homepage looks like?



Explora's smart scientists and engineers lived happily every after

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